

Stephen Foster, the great American song writer, left a heritage of beautiful songs which have become a vital part of American life – and in many other countries of the world, the lovely melodies and lively rhythms of America's genius song writer have long been popular. Stephen Foster wrote both the words and the music of his songs. Many of his songs are inspired by the beauty and sentiment of the South. Perhaps the fact that his father was a Virginian, and that his mother's home was in Maryland explains the deep appreciation of the South which is so beautifully expressed in his songs. Stephen Foster was born in Pittsburgh in 1826; he died in New York in 1864.



24. Swanee River

Stephen Foster

With expression

The musical score for "Swanee River" is presented in four systems, each with a treble and bass staff. The first system begins with a mezzo-forte (*mf*) dynamic. The second system continues the melody. The third system starts with a mezzo-piano (*mp*) dynamic. The fourth system returns to mezzo-forte (*mf*). The music features various fingerings and articulations, including slurs and accents.